Companion — caspar-AV user guide

This module runs a caspar-AV show from a Stream Deck or any other Bitfocus Companion surface. It fires cues and pads, runs transport on any screen, and shows you what CasparCG is actually doing.

The README covers installing the module. This guide is about building a surface with it.

> **Before you rely on this:** point it at **caspar-avd, the daemon**, not at CasparCG itself. Rehearse a page before a show: this drives a live playback server and there's no confirmation step.
>
> This module was built with AI assistance, directed and reviewed by a human author.

Connecting

Use the same address as the console, port **8080** by default.

Fire a cue rather than stacking transport buttons

If you only read one section, make it this one.

caspar-avd compiles a cue into **one `BEGIN` / `COMMIT` batch**, so the server locks every channel the cue touches and releases them all **on the same frame**. That's the reason cues exist at all, rather than being a list of buttons.

A Companion button that fires three separate screen actions lands them on three different frames. If a change has to happen all at once (and on a multi-screen look it usually does), put it in a cue and fire the cue.

If an action names a screen that doesn't exist, the **entire** cue fails rather than firing the bits that do resolve. Half a cue on stage is worse than none.

Three health lights, not one

Lumping them together sends people off looking for the wrong fault:

Light	Question it answers
caspar-avd is connected	Can this module reach the daemon?
CasparCG is connected	Can the daemon reach CasparCG?
OSC telemetry is arriving	Does anyone know what is on screen?

The third one's the sneaky one, and it's the one to put on every page that shows playing colour.

CasparCG won't answer any "what's playing?" question over AMCP; it *pushes* its monitor state out as OSC instead. So your commands can all work fine while the module knows nothing at all, and every "is this playing" feedback reads false. That false means **unknowable**, not **not playing**, and the difference matters when someone's deciding whether to fire a cue again.

Intent and reality are never merged

- **Screen is enabled** reads the show: what it's *configured* to do.
- **Screen is playing / paused / playing a specific file / near its end** read telemetry: what CasparCG is *actually* doing.

caspar-avd never mixes the two, and neither does this module. **If they disagree, that tells you something.** It isn't a bug for anything to smooth over.

Clip near its end is worth a button of its own on a show where something has to follow a clip out.

The pad grid survives a re-lay-out

Pad presets fire by **pad position** rather than by cue id, so a Stream Deck laid out to match the grid stays right when the show gets re-laid out.

The blue feedback lights while that pad still holds the cue the button was built for. When the show changes underneath you, the button still fires the right *pad*, and the blue tells you whether it's still the cue you meant.

Raw AMCP, and the mistake everyone makes

A two-word AMCP command puts its target **between** the words:

```
MIXER 1-10 FILL 0 0 0.5 0.5      ✓
MIXER FILL 1-10 0 0 0.5 0.5      ✗ 400 ERROR
```

Batches can answer **COMMIT PARTIAL**, which means a command inside failed. The module logs that as a warning rather than letting it pass as a success, so if a batch looked fine but didn't land, check the log.

---

media-scanner is not optional

In CasparCG 2.5 the media and thumbnail commands get **passed on to media-scanner**, and answer 501 if it isn't running.

The **SCANNER** preset shows its state and refreshes the library when you press it. If media commands come back 501, look there first.

Building a surface that fails safe

1. **Cues for anything that has to happen all at once.** Transport buttons are for single-screen work.
2. **All three health lights** on the main page.
3. **OSC telemetry** on any page with playing colour, specifically. Without it the colour lies by omission.
4. **A pad grid that matches the show's grid**, so muscle memory carries over.
5. **Near-its-end** where the operator can see it, if anything has to follow a clip out.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Cause
Every "playing" light is off but video is on screen	OSC telemetry is not arriving. It is unknowable, not stopped.
A multi-screen change arrives ragged	Separate transport actions on one button land on separate frames. Use a cue.
A cue fired nothing at all	One of its actions names a screen that does not exist, and that fails the whole cue by design.
A raw AMCP command returns 400	Two-word command with the target in the wrong place. See above.
Media commands return 501	media-scanner is not running.
A batch reported success but only half landed	Look for COMMIT PARTIAL in the log.

See also

- README: installing, and the full list of actions, feedbacks and variables
- `companion/HELP.md`: the same material, in Companion's help panel